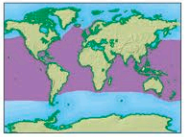


Lampris guttatus

Opah

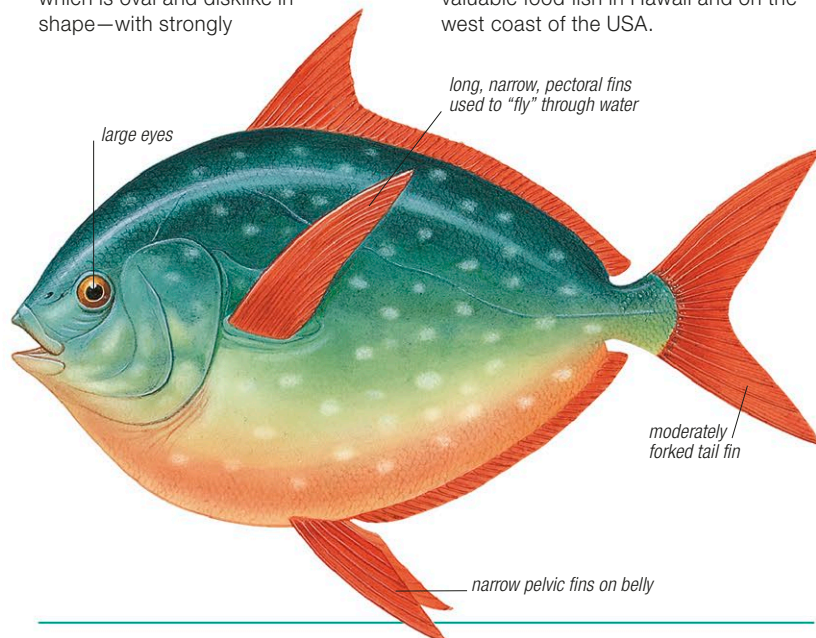


Length Up to 6 ft (1.8 m)
Weight 160 lb (73 kg)
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location Tropical, subtropical, and temperate waters worldwide

Also known as the moonfish, this large fish is an oceanic predator. The opah has large eyes, a silvery blue body—which is oval and disklike in shape—with strongly

contrasting, deep red fins. Unlike most fishes, which swim using their tail, the opah swims with its pectoral fins, beating them up and down like a pair of wings. The fins are long and stiff, with a narrow profile that minimizes drag as they slice through the water. Despite its toothless mouth and large size—the maximum recorded weight of a specimen is 160 lb (73 kg)—the opah is well known as a very efficient predator, energetically pursuing small fishes and squid. It is found throughout the world but is most common in the North Atlantic and North Pacific oceans. An inhabitant of mid-water levels, the opah is taken on long lines and with gill nets, and is a valuable food fish in Hawaii and on the west coast of the USA.

*Cleidopus gloriamaris*

Pineapplefish



Length 11 in (28 cm)
Weight 18 oz (500 g)
Sex Male/Female
Status Not evaluated

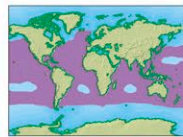
Location Indo-Pacific

The pineapplefish gets its name from its shape, and from its large, black-edged scales, which look like the segments of pineapple skin. It belongs to a family of fishes that are protected by bony armor, and by sharp spines on their dorsal and pelvic fins. This particular

species has a bioluminescent organ on the lower jaw—orange during the day, glowing blue-green at night—covered by the upper jaw when the mouth is closed. Because this mainly solitary fish ventures out at night from the depths of dark caves, curious small fishes, crustaceans, and other invertebrates are attracted by the glowing organ on its lower jaw, and are caught and eaten. There is only one other genus in this family, the pinecone fish, which has its bioluminescent organ on the upper instead of the lower jaw. The bizarre appearance of the pineapplefish makes it extremely popular in the aquarium trade. However, only a skilled aquarist is capable of keeping it alive and well in captivity.

*Trachipterus trachipterus*

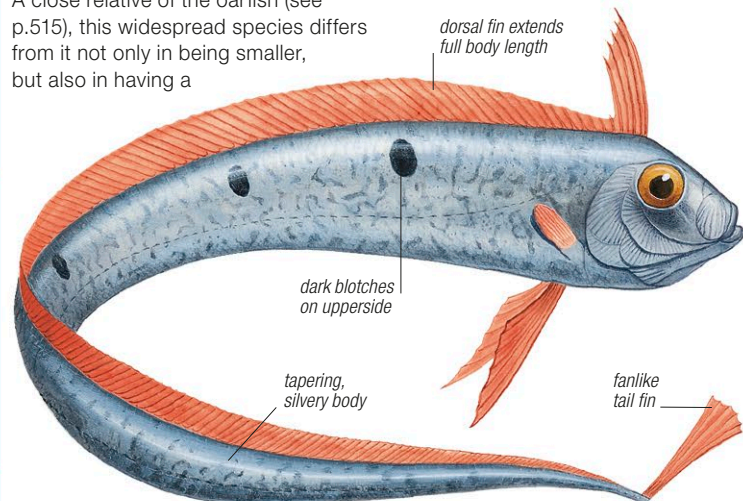
Mediterranean dealfish



Length Up to 9¼ ft (3 m)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location Mediterranean, E. Atlantic, Indian Ocean, C. and W. Pacific

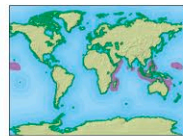
A close relative of the oarfish (see p.515), this widespread species differs from it not only in being smaller, but also in having a



body that tapers rapidly towards its tail, ending in a tiny, upturned, fanlike fin. It usually has a pattern of 1–4 widely spaced dark blotches on the upper body and one or 2 blotches on the underside; it has no scales. As in the oarfish, its dorsal fin is deep red in color. This carnivore feeds on mid-water fishes and squid, and depends on its large size for protection against predators. Its eggs and larvae are often found in Mediterranean waters but there is little information on its reproductive behavior. The Mediterranean dealfish family contains 11 species; all are rare, and their biology is poorly known.

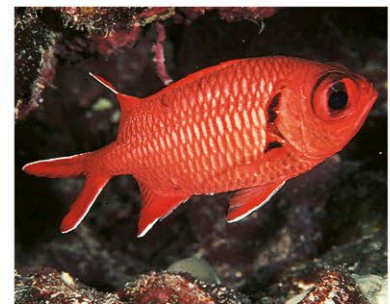
Myripristis murdjan

Pinecone soldierfish



Length Up to 12 in (30 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location Pacific, Indian Ocean

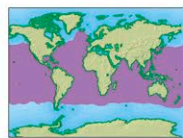


The pinecone soldierfish lives on rocky and coral reefs, hiding in crevices during the day and coming out at night to feed on plankton, such as crustacean larvae. It swims with quick, jerky movements, propelled by a deeply forked tail. Like

many nocturnal fishes, it has large eyes. The body scales are large, sharp, and very rough, and the spines on the fins and gill covers help deter predators. Its red fins are edged with white. The pinecone soldierfish is capable of producing a chattering noise, but why it does this is not known.

Anoplogaster cornuta

Common fangtooth



Length 7 in (18 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Sex Male/Female
Status Least concern

Location Tropical, subtropical, and temperate waters worldwide

Like many deep-sea fishes, the common fangtooth has a small body and a disproportionately large head—an adaptation for eating prey that can be almost

as big as itself. This cruising predator uses its large teeth to impale its prey, which it traps with rapid, lunging movements. Young common fangtooths look very different from their parents, and at one time were mistakenly classified as a separate species. Adults have a brown to black body, head, and fins, while juveniles are silvery. Adult common fangtooths inhabit greater depths than the young.

